

error and find out where this command is placed. This of course, varies from flavour to flavour, and with the desktop environment (KDE / Gnome). So, have fun exploring the GUI. But the fastest way to do it is as above.

### 2.5.3 Even more commands

In any OS, a command is an instruction given to the computer to do a particular task, such as moving files, renaming files, or opening a program (which itself will contain a lot of other files). In fact, everything you do boils down to commands. When you click on an icon, a command is called to open the file or application that appears as the icon. Every OS has its own set of commands. Some have only commands and not a graphical interface, such as DOS, while Windows allows both command-line and graphical interfaces. Linux is available in both GUI and command-line-only versions. But when Linux is used as a server, the GUI is not installed, so as to optimise resources for performance.

We've mentioned how to bring up the terminal. Once your terminal is opened you can start experimenting with the various commands. Before that, try and get some of the basics of Linux commands so you won't get lost along your way.

One of the first things you would want to know is how to get out of the terminal. Remember the DOS "*exit*" command? Well, the same thing works here. Type "*exit*" and press *[Enter]* to close the terminal and return to your desktop.

If you are doing a task that will take a long time to execute—like copying a large video file—you need not wait until the process is over in order to try another command. (It makes for a funny sight when someone just sits staring at the screen doing nothing, waiting for something to happen!) After any command, just add the "&" character (for example, "*cp x y &*") and that process will get executed in the background while the terminal will be available for you to do something else.